



AFROBEAT • AFROFUNK • WORLD MUSIC • SANTIAGO, CHILE • 2009

Newen Afrobeat

BIOGRAPHY

Newen Afrobeat is the first Chilean afrobeat orchestra: an eleven-piece formation that takes the language founded by Fela Kuti in Lagos and writes it from the southern hemisphere, without imitation and without pose.

Formed in Santiago in 2009, the band went through a decade of slow gestation before traveling to Lagos to study with masters of the genre. That pilgrimage marked the break between genre exercise and self-voice: from their second LP *Curiche* (2019), the band took on situated themes —inequality, migration, women's roles, indigenous cultures— without letting go of classic afrobeat's rhythmic urgency.

The catalogue counts five releases: the debut LP *Newen Afrobeat* (2014, Estudios del Sur), the EP *Newen Plays Fela* (2017) recorded with Seun Kuti, Cheick Tidiane Seck and Egypt 80 musicians, the LP *Curiche* (2019), the LP *Grietas* (OfficeHome Records, Paris, 2024) featuring Lido Pimienta, Dele Sosimi, Joe Vasconcellos and Chico César, and the live session *Liverpool Session* (2025) recorded fully analog at Quarry, Liverpool.

The sound dialogues with highlife, modal jazz, funk and rare groove, but operates from a South American reading of afrobeat trance: dense brass sections, percussions crossing kpalongos, sakara, congas and drums; voices in Spanish, English and Yoruba. The expanded section —vocals, three brass, two saxophones, guitars, bass, percussion and drums— allows them to stretch pieces to 9-13 minutes without losing pulse, an aesthetic rather than a commercial decision.

They have collaborated with Tony Allen, Seun Kuti, Femi Kuti, Cheick Tidiane Seck, Oghene Kologbo, Lido Pimienta, Joe Vasconcellos, Dele Sosimi and Chico César. Within the PHŌNÉ ecosystem, Ecamhi plays as historic trumpet player and co-composer of *Mare Mare*, and Klaus Brantmayer signs the composition of *Es la Vida*; Claudio Solís designs the graphic art of the LP *Grietas*.

They have toured Chile, Brazil, Nigeria, the United States, Canada, the United Kingdom and Europe, with a notable presentation at Glastonbury. The Europe 2026 tour (August-September) takes them to Innsbruck, Frick, Frankfurt, Geneva, Vienna, Manchester, Jazz Cafe in London and Festival Ethnos in Naples, with management shared between PHŌNÉ Records (Chile) and Ludwig Sound Booking Agency (Heidelberg, Germany).

DISCOGRAPHY

2025-04 **Liverpool Session**
EP en vivo · 4 tracks

2024-09 **Grietas**
LP · vinilo + digital · OfficeHome Records (París)

2019-05 **Curiche**
2° LP · 7 tracks

2017-02 **Newen Plays Fela**
EP · CD (sold out)

2014-06 **Newen Afrobeat**
LP debut · 7 tracks

LINKS

BANDCAMP <https://newenafrobeat.bandcamp.com/music>

YOUTUBE <https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCTHMwr5NTvQ0MWbq0nbeP-w>

SPOTIFY <https://open.spotify.com/artist/0PTJ848uLSHbjTx2yqaAlb>

INSTAGRAM <https://www.instagram.com/newenafrobeat/>



About PHONÉ Records

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PHONÉ Records is an independent cultural label with strong authorial direction, oriented towards the integral production of situated musical works and the strategic care of artistic trajectories. We operate at the intersection of creation, management, circulation and memory.

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